

Jason Jiayu Zhang

Design Engineer

jason.zhangjiayu.com
linkedin.com/in/jason-jiayu-zhang
jason.jiayu.zhang@gmail.com
+1 (916) 260-6067

Products

Cattlelog Product Designer & UI Engineer

Mar 2025 – Present

- Architected a production-ready design system using React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, leveraging Headless UI and Radix UI to maintain strict parity between Figma design tokens and production code for 40,000+ users.
- Engineered a modular library of accessible components using Framer Motion for micro-interactions and Recharts for dynamic grade distribution visualizations, accelerating frontend delivery by 30% through a Vite pipeline.
- Optimized Cattlelog performance and search discovery by 25% through TanStack Virtual for list virtualization and TanStack Query for state management, validating improvements through PostHog behavior analytics.

Fimanu Full Stack Designer & Developer

Jan 2026 – Present

- Designed and developed a full-stack productivity platform from scratch, utilizing React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS to translate raw user data into interactive heatmap visualizations.
- Authored data integrations to capture real-time design metadata, utilizing Figma OAuth for secure user access and the Figma REST API for database updates and synchronization.
- Conducted end-to-end usability testing to validate complex data-visualization interfaces, recording a 95% success rate in user task completion and executing all subsequent UI iterations.

Spot Product Designer

Feb 2025

- Identified a critical efficiency gap in campus infrastructure and a core campus pain point to conceptualize a real-time mapping application to dynamically track study location availability.
- Validated product-market fit through mixed-methods research (50+ surveys, 5 interviews), synthesizing qualitative data to drive 4 rapid iterations of the core user journey.
- Delivered end-to-end user flows, branding, and high-fidelity Figma prototypes in under 24 hours through a comprehensive product pitch, culminating in a 1st-place winning pitch among 20+ competing products.

Experience

Figma Campus Ambassador

Jul 2025 – Present

- Pioneered the inaugural Figma campus chapter at UC Davis, scaling a design outreach initiative to 1,000+ students across 20+ disciplines through high-impact workshops on design systems and rapid prototyping.
- Mentored 50+ aspiring designers on industry-standard workflows, providing portfolio critiques and technical guidance that assisted peers in securing internships at Tier-1 tech firms.

Product Space @ UC Davis Vice President of Design

Oct 2025 – Jan 2026

- Directed the visual identity and UI/UX strategy for the fellowship's digital presence, implementing conversion-centered design that boosted application click-through rates by 15% per quarter.
- Managed a creative pipeline, overseeing the production of 45+ multi-channel assets for 2 recruitment cycles while ensuring brand consistency across social, web, and presentation platforms.

Education

University of California – Davis Design B.A., Computer Engineering B.S.

Sep 2024 – Jun 2027

Design / AI Tools

Figma + Figma MCP,
Antigravity,
Adobe Cloud Suite,
Claude Code,
Google Stitch,
Sketch

Programming

TypeScript,
Git / GitHub,
HTML / CSS / JS,
React / React Native,
Tailwind, Vite,
Python, Java,
C / C++

Awards

Best Overall @ *ProdCon 2026*

Best Design @ *Product Showcase*

Honorable Mention @ *Davis Design Fest*

Skills

A/B testing,
Agentic workflows,
AI-integrated design,
CLI design,
Copywriting,
Design engineering,
Design systems,
Design validation,
Developer workflows,
Frontend development,
Information architecture,
Journey mapping,
Product analytics,
Product strategy,
Prototyping,
Responsive design,
Storyboarding,
UI/UX design,
Usability testing,
User interviews,
User personas,
User research,
UX writing,
Visual design,
Wireframing

